01 | AT YOUR DESK

CCEs: check the message

Use when writing, reading, or passing along work direction.

When the directive applies

Leadership written expectations, changes, decisions, and work reminders use CCEs 1–5. Include CCE 6 whenever applicable. Greetings and receipt-only replies do not require the template.

Element	Check for a usable answer
1. What is changing or being asked	Who must do what, and by when?
2. Why / Why it is changing	Explain the reason the work or change is needed.
3. Who owns it and who decides	Name the person doing the work and the person who may decide.
4. What is not changing	State which duties, rules, deadlines, or approvals stay in place.
5. What to do if it is unclear, and when you will hear back	Name the contact route and when to expect a reply or update.
6. Where this lives (whenever applicable)	Point to the correct form, policy, guide, or other source when one applies.

Before sending or passing it along

Keep the approved action, reason, deadline, audience, and decision authority intact. Use clearer words without changing the direction. Confirm missing facts instead of filling gaps with a guess.

When you are receiving direction

> *"I understand that I need to _____ by _____. I am responsible for _____. I still need to confirm _____ with _____."*

One final check

Could the reader explain the next action, timing, and route for help? A link supports a clear message; it does not replace one.

Training basis: Communicating CLEAR, final series, slides 11–19 and 37–41.